ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 10: **Life on Earth (Geography)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** ecological commons	Shared resource
2	**(a)** energy is lost at each level	Energy flow
3	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A false
4	**(d)** Tundra - hot	Tundra is cold
5	**(d)** wildlife corridors	Connectivity
6	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A false
7	**(a)** traditional water conservation	Commons
8	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Favourable climate
9	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Warmth and rainfall all year support a huge variety of plants and animals.
10	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both are true but the second does not explain the first.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Reduces cover (1); Soil erosion (1).	1+1
12	Local ownership (1); Fair benefits (1).	1+1
13	Different climates (1); Different food and water (1).	1+1
14	Nutrients cycle quickly in plants (1); Heavy rain leaches soil (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Fodder and fuel (1); Fish (1); No private alternatives (1).	1+1+1
16	Herbs (1); Remedies (1); Documentation (1).	1+1+1
17	Gram Sabha consent (1); Livelihood loss (1); Legal rights (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Dry versus wet (1); Few versus many (1); Poor versus nutrient cycle (1).	1+1+1
18	Few species (1); Permafrost melt (1); Fragile chain (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Shared use (1); Rules (1); Festivals (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Emergent layer (1). (ii) Steppes (1). (iii) Taiga (1). (iv) Because it has a huge variety of species and genetic resources (2).	1+1+1+2
20	Legal protection (1); Market (1); Quality control (1); Producers' welfare (1); Need for support (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Beliefs (1); Rules (1); Water (1); Forest (1); Continuity (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- A **biome** is a large natural region with similar climate, plants and animals; do not use it interchangeably with ecosystem or habitat.
- Energy **decreases** at higher levels of a food pyramid (lost as heat); top consumers are the fewest, and a food chain starts with producers.
- Match biomes correctly: taiga - coniferous trees; steppes - Asian grasslands; tundra - coldest; Gobi - cold desert; Rann of Kutch - salt desert; savanna - lions.
- A GI tag identifies a product by its place of origin (e.g. Nilgiri Tea, Khasi Mandarin); it is not a tag for quality alone or for the producer's name.
- Forest Rights Act = 2006; Chipko = Uttarakhand; Thenmala = India's first planned ecotourism destination; sacred groves are protected by religious belief.
- Commons are shared resources, not private property; wildlife corridors connect habitats instead of separating them.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 10: **Life on Earth (Geography)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** freshwater	Aquatic
2	**(c)** community forest governance	Mendha Lekha
3	**(a)** rules for sustainable catch	Management
4	**(c)** PM Ujjwala	Clean fuel
5	**(d)** Biodiversity includes genes, species and ecosystems	Wide concept
6	**(b)** Prairies - North America	Match
7	**(a)** Encroachment	Pressure
8	**(a)** protection of brand and price	IP right
9	**(c)** A is true but R is false.	Corridors connect fragmented habitats, so R is false.
10	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	Commons are shared, not private, so A is false.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Crop yield (1); Biodiversity (1).	1+1
12	Value traditional varieties (1); Encourage farmers to keep them (1).	1+1
13	Land conversion (1); Climate change (1).	1+1
14	Absorb CO2 (1); Release moisture (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Reduces exploitation (1); But tourist pressure (1); Needs limits (1).	1+1+1
16	Elephant movement (1); Gene flow (1); Reduce conflict (1).	1+1+1
17	Health and education (1); Fair prices (1); Rights recognition (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Dense populations (1); Resource use (1); Conservation conflict (1).	1+1+1
18	Rajasthan versus Uttarakhand (1); Amrita Devi versus women (1); Both non-violent (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Herbivores increase (1); Plants overgrazed (1); Imbalance (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Producers (1). (ii) It is lost as heat at each level (1). (iii) It lets animals move between habitats and helps gene flow (1). (iv) Because only a small part of the energy reaches the top, which can support only a few consumers (2).	1+1+1+2
20	Definition (1); Tanks (1); Fisheries (1); Threats (1); Revival (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Food (1); Medicine (1); Climate (1); Pollination (1); Cultural values (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- A **biome** is a large natural region with similar climate, plants and animals; do not use it interchangeably with ecosystem or habitat.
- Energy **decreases** at higher levels of a food pyramid (lost as heat); top consumers are the fewest, and a food chain starts with producers.
- Match biomes correctly: taiga - coniferous trees; steppes - Asian grasslands; tundra - coldest; Gobi - cold desert; Rann of Kutch - salt desert; savanna - lions.
- A GI tag identifies a product by its place of origin (e.g. Nilgiri Tea, Khasi Mandarin); it is not a tag for quality alone or for the producer's name.
- Forest Rights Act = 2006; Chipko = Uttarakhand; Thenmala = India's first planned ecotourism destination; sacred groves are protected by religious belief.
- Commons are shared resources, not private property; wildlife corridors connect habitats instead of separating them.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 10: **Life on Earth (Geography)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A false; R true
2	**(c)** Khasi Mandarin - Meghalaya	Match
3	**(b)** participatory governance	Community role
4	**(b)** grassland	Savanna-type
5	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Climate-driven
6	**(b)** Jammu and Kashmir	State
7	**(a)** forest fires	Fire risk
8	**(a)** forest	NTFPs
9	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	So little energy remains for higher levels that the chain cannot go on indefinitely.
10	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both are true but unrelated: cacti store water in their stems.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Local control (1); Responsibility for forests (1).	1+1
12	Melting ice (1); Habitat loss (1).	1+1
13	Fertile soils (1); Cattle and cereals (1).	1+1
14	Protect reputation (1); Maintain tag (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Monitor (1); Share knowledge (1); Earn income (1).	1+1+1
16	Overfishing (1); Conflict (1); Stock decline (1).	1+1+1
17	Link to place (1); Quality and tradition (1); Income and protection (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Salinity (1); Species (1); Uses (1).	1+1+1
18	Loss of habitat (1); Smoke (1); Fire lines and awareness (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Store rainwater (1); Recharge wells (1); Irrigate (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Uttarakhand (1). (ii) 2006 (1). (iii) Our village, our rule (1). (iv) It identifies a product by its place of origin (1); it protects the brand and helps producers get a better price (1).	1+1+1+2
20	FRA (1); Gram Sabha (1); GI tags (1); NTFP prices (1); Sustainability (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Sacred groves (1); Bishnoi and Chipko (1); Protected areas (1); FRA (1); Technology (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- A **biome** is a large natural region with similar climate, plants and animals; do not use it interchangeably with ecosystem or habitat.
- Energy **decreases** at higher levels of a food pyramid (lost as heat); top consumers are the fewest, and a food chain starts with producers.
- Match biomes correctly: taiga - coniferous trees; steppes - Asian grasslands; tundra - coldest; Gobi - cold desert; Rann of Kutch - salt desert; savanna - lions.
- A GI tag identifies a product by its place of origin (e.g. Nilgiri Tea, Khasi Mandarin); it is not a tag for quality alone or for the producer's name.
- Forest Rights Act = 2006; Chipko = Uttarakhand; Thenmala = India's first planned ecotourism destination; sacred groves are protected by religious belief.
- Commons are shared resources, not private property; wildlife corridors connect habitats instead of separating them.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND